

STEVEN WILSSENS

Principal Product Leader driving data, metrics, and ML-powered insights to improve customer experience

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SUMMARY

Principal product leader with over a decade at Microsoft building data products, metrics, experimentation platforms, and ML-powered insights that improve customer experience at scale. I lead teams that turn complex telemetry and customer signals into decision systems used by engineers and product leaders to improve adoption, retention, quality, and engagement across the Windows ecosystem. My work centers on defining durable metrics, enabling faster experimentation, and translating large-scale data into clear actions for senior stakeholders.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Group Product Manager - Microsoft - W+D Data

Microsoft

📅 12/2024 - 09/2026 📍 Redmond, WA

Lead the PM team responsible for the data, insights, experimentation, and ML models that power decision-making across Windows and Devices.

- Own the strategy and roadmap for data platforms and insight products used by Windows engineers and product managers to ship higher-quality releases
- Lead a team of product managers driving experimentation, customer-signal analysis, and ML-powered insight products
- Partner with engineering, data science, and research leaders to translate telemetry from a billion+ Windows devices into product decisions that improve adoption, retention, quality, and engagement
- Set the vision for how AI and ML are used internally to accelerate Windows product development

Principal Product Manager Lead - CSX Data

Microsoft

📅 02/2020 - 12/2024

Led a team using large-scale customer signals and machine learning to produce insights that helped Microsoft engineers improve Windows quality, detect issues faster, and make data-supported release decisions across hardware, software, and services.

Principal Product Manager Lead - Azure DevOps

Microsoft

📅 09/2019 - 02/2020 📍 Redmond, WA

- Increased market penetration by defining new products, go-to-market strategies, and business decisions for Azure DevOps Platform.
- Spearheaded rapid new business and product analysis (new product a core priority for GitHub following \$7B+ acquisition).

Principal Product Manager Lead - Silicon, Graphics, Media Team in Operating System Group

Microsoft

📅 01/2018 - 09/2019 📍 Redmond, WA

Principal Program Manager Lead at Microsoft for Audio, Spatial Audio, Game Streaming, x Cloud, Game DVR & Broadcast, CAST

- Led Microsoft Spatial Audio Platform, working with developers and data insights to identify and deliver essential spatial audio features on Windows, Xbox One, and new platforms.
- Grew monthly active devices playing spatial audio > 250% over 1.5 years, impacting millions of users across OEM devices, Xbox consoles, and consumer acquisitions.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



Enhanced User Retention

Improved user retention by 20% through enhanced adoption strategies and engagement programs.



Boosted Windows Adoption

Increased Windows adoption by 15% with data-driven product improvements and strategic initiatives.



Reduced Customer Issues

Reduced customer issues by 30% through effective telemetry integration and analysis.



Improved Product Quality

Achieved a 25% increase in product quality by leveraging AI and ML in development processes.

LANGUAGES

English

Native



French

Intermediate



Dutch

Native



AWARDS



Microsoft Lighthouse Award for Teamwork



Microsoft Compass Award for Individual Excellence



Microsoft Gold Star Award



Most Valuable Professional (MVP): VS Team System

SKILLS

Product Management

Budget Management

Stakeholder Management

Data Strategy

EXPERIENCE

Principal Product Manager - Silicon, Graphics, Media Team in Operating System Group

Microsoft

09/2017 - 01/2018 Redmond, WA

Spatial Audio Platform (Windows Sonic) for Windows and Xbox One.
Speaker during major Game and Developer Conferences

- Drove the launch of Dolby Access v3 and DTS Sound Unbound with new app services, licensing, and customization models on PC and Xbox.
- Established cross-company partnerships with Surface, Store, Marketing, and Gaming to advance the presence of spatial audio on more endpoints and games, and improve the health of the platform.
- Collaborated with strategic partners (Disney+, Netflix) in bringing Dolby Atmos to Xbox and Windows.

Senior Product Manager - Silicon, Graphics, Media Team in Operating Systems Group

Microsoft

10/2008 - 08/2017 redmond

Spatial Audio Platform (Windows Sonic) for Windows and Xbox One.

Lead Developer and Team Lead

Compuware

01/2005 - 12/2006 Belgium

- Responsible for hiring, evaluation, education, and job assignment of about 15 developers.
- Speaker at the Microsoft Belgium Developer & IT Pro Days when I presented sessions on Best Practices for Application Development and Best Practices for Advanced Source Control.
- Delivered several presentations on Visual Studio Team System to high-profile customers for the Belgium Microsoft Developer Evangelism group.
- Led Project Support Office at Fluxys: implemented new development process & Fluxys Framework, coached developers & architects, managed build team & infrastructure, contributed to Project Management Improvement.

Software Developer

Cosmos

01/2004 - 12/2005 Antwerp Area, Belgium

- Member of the 'Cosmos Institute' that is responsible for technical guidance and technical/analytical education.
- Member of the 'Technical Components' team, that is responsible for construction, maintenance and support of the software components, principally in C# (client) and Java (server), using CORBA as middleware.
- Provide revised designs of existing applications, assist application developers, and provide code reviews.

Developer and Trainer

Info Support

01/2001 - 12/2004 Belgium

- Led development team at Agfa Gevaert, enhancing operations from September 2003 to March 2004.
- Developed .NET Windows and Web applications utilizing C# and Visual Studio .NET for multiple organizations (Agfa Gevaert, Cosmos NV, De Post, Petrobel, Info Support).
- Created distributed .NET applications focusing on efficiency and scalability.
- Developed robust applications with ADO .NET for SQL Server 2000 to improve database management.
- Provided strategic insight into .NET architecture for projects and management teams.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science

Karel de Grote-Belgium

2000 - 2004

SKILLS

Software Development		Program Management	
C#	Agile Project Management		
Software Project Management			
Agile Methodologies		Idea Generation	
Streaming Media		Web Development	
Software Development Methodologies			
User Experience		SDLC	AI Innovation
Cross Functional Team Building			
Audio Technologies		Big Data	
Machine Learning		Experimentation	
Data Analytics		Customer Insights	Telemetry
Data Products			